

Deborah Onakoya

Customer Service Specialist | Virtual Assistant | Phone Support Expert
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Profile

Customer-focused Virtual Assistant and Customer Service Specialist with 3+ years of experience delivering seamless client support across phone, email, and digital platforms. Skilled at resolving complex inquiries, guiding customers through solutions, and building trust through clear, empathetic communication. Adept at thriving in fast-paced, high-volume environments while maintaining accuracy and professionalism. Proficient in Microsoft Office Suite, CRM systems, and remote collaboration tools. Driven by a passion for creating exceptional customer experiences and adding value to every interaction.

Work Experience

Customer Support Representative | ASAPTICKETS | Remote | 2024

- Handled 300+ inbound calls monthly from U.S.-based and international customers to resolve travel discrepancies such as itinerary changes, cancellations, lost reservations, or special requests, ensuring compliance with airline and agency policies.
- Responded to 15+ daily emails including booking confirmations, refund requests, adjustments, and general queries, while maintaining high quality standards (accuracy, politeness, timeliness).
- Assisted customers with booking complex multi-leg or last-minute flights, using internal tools and consolidator fare systems, negotiating where possible, and providing clear options (cost, travel time, layovers).
- Monitored customer satisfaction through feedback (surveys, post-interaction follow ups), identifying recurring issues and escalating to management for process improvements.
- Maintained detailed records of customer interactions in the agency's CRM or booking system, ensuring all follow-ups, ticketing documentation, cancellations, amendments were updated accurately.
- Ensured compliance with company policies and international travel regulations (visa/entry requirements, airline booking rules), and explained these to clients as needed.
- Collaborated with other teams (ticketing, billing, quality assurance) to solve disputes and ensure refunds or credits are processed correctly, verifying any additional fees or supplier policies.

Sales Advisor | AXA Mansard Insurance | 2024

- Proactively reached out (outbound calls or via referrals) to potential customers to present life and health insurance policies, tailoring policy recommendations based on client needs (age, family, health history).
- Explained key features, benefits, terms and limitations of different policies, helping clients make informed decisions (waiting periods, premium schedules, exclusions).
- Followed up leads and past clients to renew policies, cross-sell additional coverage or upgrades, ensuring retention and revenue growth.

- Managed and resolved customer complaints: investigating and liaising with underwriting, claims departments, clarifying misinterpretations of policy, ensuring satisfaction while balancing risk to company.
- Maintained accurate, up-to-date records of all client interactions, sales transactions, policy documents, e-mails, ensuring regulatory compliance and internal audit readiness.
- Achieved or exceeded assigned sales targets or quotas, collaborating with marketing or product teams to align on promotions or product offerings.
- Kept abreast of regulatory changes, new insurance products, market trends to provide accurate advice and promote competitive offerings.

Personal Assistant | Federal Ministry of Women Affairs, Abuja (NYSC) | 2021–2022

- Managed the Deputy Director's complex calendar: scheduling official meetings, coordinating with other government departments, organizing traveling schedule, ensuring no conflicts and timely preparation for meetings.
- Prepared briefing materials, correspondence, reports for the Deputy Director: gathering data, drafting memos, preparing notes to support decisions or policy implementation.
- Took comprehensive minutes during official meetings and ensured follow-up on action items: tracking responsibilities, deadlines, and reporting back on progress.
- Supported event organization and logistics for ministry programs: venue booking, stakeholder invitations, procurement of supplies, coordination on logistics for workshops or seminars.
- Handled travel and accommodation planning for official trips, visa/permit arrangements if needed, creating itineraries and ensuring successful execution.
- Maintained and organized sensitive files and records, ensuring security and confidentiality of documentation; managed communication channels, interfaced with stakeholders on behalf of the Deputy Director.
- Assisted with ad-hoc tasks: research, data collection, drafting letters/emails, supervising junior administrative staff or interns if assigned.

Creative Lead | Arewarose Ville | 2019–Present

- Founded and led a not-for-profit enterprise focused on empowering young entrepreneurs
- Organized a large-scale beauty pageantry event with over 150 participants in Ekiti State

Education

Bachelor of Science in Business Administration | Federal University, Oye Ekiti | 2021

Certifications

- Business Data Analytics – Udemy | Completed 2022
- Virtual Assistant – Udemy | Completed 2022

Skills

- Call Handling
- Conflict Resolution
- Customer Retention
- Product Education

- Microsoft Word & Excel
- CRM Tools & Zoom
- Remote Collaboration

Volunteering Experience

- Red Cross Community Development Group (NYSC) | 2021–2022
- Participated in outreach to Wuye Village to educate locals on basic first aid and deliver medical services